Time Management

Plan your time, start strong, and protect your energy. Try a few this week and keep what works.

01 Plan it *Know what's coming and how long it takes*

Write it all in one place

Every assignment, test, and due date goes in one planner or calendar as soon as it's posted. Not in your head.

TRY IT
Check Canvas after school and add anything new to your planner.

Block out your week

Every Sunday, put in classes, practices, and meals first. Then give homework its own blocks in the gaps.

TRY IT
Tue 4:00 to 5:00 is chemistry. Wed after practice is the essay.

Time it, then trust it

For one week, write down how long homework really takes. Plan with those numbers, not your guess.

TRY IT
Guessed 30 minutes, took 50? Plan 50.

Break it down, spread it out. Split a big project into small steps and give each step its own day, so nothing lands on the night before. Here's a paper due in two weeks.

WEEK 1

MON Pick a topic → WED Find sources → FRI Outline

WEEK 2

MON Draft → WED Revise and finish → FRI Due

Sort your list. Too much to do? Put each task in a box by how soon it's due and how much it matters.

	DUE SOON	NOT DUE SOON
MATTERS A LOT	**Do it now** *Test tomorrow, essay due Friday*	**Schedule it** *Project due in two weeks, finals*
MATTERS LESS	**Keep it short** *Club form, quick email to a teacher. Set a time limit.*	**Save it for later** *Recopying notes neatly, color-coding your planner*

Time Management

02 Start it *Get going when you don't feel like it*

Hardest thing first

Start with the task you're dreading while your energy is highest. Easy tasks feel productive, but they let the hard ones pile up.

TRY IT
Essay draft first, vocab flashcards last.

Five-minute rule

If it takes five minutes or less, do it now. If it takes longer, write down exactly when you'll do it so it stops nagging you.

TRY IT
Sign the form now. Lab report goes on Tuesday at 4.

If-then plans

Link work to something you already do: "When X, then I'll Y." Make one for whatever usually gets in your way, too.

TRY IT
"If I grab my phone, then it goes in the kitchen."

Know your best hours

Notice the time of day you focus best, and save your hardest work for those hours.

TRY IT
Sharpest after a snack at 4? That's essay time.

03 Protect your energy *Stay focused without burning out*

Plan in breaks

Decide your breaks before you start, like 5 minutes after every 25. Get up and move. Planned breaks keep you fresher than pushing until you're fried.

TRY IT
Timer for 25, then walk, stretch, or refill your water.

Cut digital distractions

Notifications pull your focus even when you ignore them. Turn them off, close extra tabs, and put your phone in another room.

TRY IT
Do Not Disturb on, phone in the kitchen.

Plan free time loosely

Put fun on a day, not a set time. Free time with no clock attached stays fun.

TRY IT
"Friends Saturday afternoon," not "at 2:00."

Protect your sleep

Teens need 8 to 10 hours. Sleep is when your brain locks in what you learned, so late nights cost tomorrow's focus.

TRY IT
Pick a homework stop time and keep it.